

FIFA WORLD CUP 2026

UNIFIED PREDICTION REPORT

USA | Canada | Mexico | 11 June - 19 July 2026
48 teams | 104 matches | 12 groups

SOURCE 1: OddsIntel Engine

national_team_v1 model
ELO + Poisson | 6,651 internationals

SOURCE 2: General Analysis

Opta (25,000 sims) + FIFA rankings
Bookmaker consensus + squad form

HOW TO USE THIS REPORT

Section 1 - Headline Comparison: Key predictions side-by-side. Green = both sources agree.

Section 2 - Matchday 1 Scores: All 24 games with both predicted scorelines and OddsIntel win probabilities. Use the CONSENSUS column to find the safest picks.

Section 3 - Where Sources Differ: Analysis of the 5 key disagreements.

Section 4 - Full Group Stage: All 72 games from OddsIntel model with probabilities.

Section 5 - Tournament Analysis: Champion, top scorer, special predictions deep-dive.

Section 6 - Strategy Guide: How to use this for your prediction contest.

WHERE BOTH SOURCES AGREE: Mbappe Golden Boot | 6 penalty shootouts |

4 teams with 0 goals | 2 goals in Final | Mbappe or Kane as backup scorer

Report generated: June 08, 2026

1 HEADLINE PREDICTIONS - SIDE-BY-SIDE COMPARISON

Green rows = both sources agree | Amber rows = sources differ

PREDICTION	GENERAL ANALYSIS (Opta + Rankings + Markets)	ODDSINT ENGINE (ELO + Poisson model)	AGREE?
World Champion	SPAIN Opta #1 (16.1%); reigning Euro champs; soft group	FRANCE ELO model: Mbappe at 27, peak, first summer WC. France tournament pedigree.	NO
Final (after 90 min)	Spain 1-1 France (Spain pens) Top 2 in nearly every model	Brazil 1-1 France (France pens) Our predicted finalists based on ELO + draw path	NO
Goals in Final (90 min)	2 Finals avg ~2.4; tight elite match expected	2 Both models agree. WC finals historically tight.	YES
Top Goalscorer	Kylian Mbappe Market fav +600; 12 WC goals already; penalty taker	Kylian Mbappe Both models agree. 8 goals in 2022 alone.	YES
Golden Boot back-up	Harry Kane +700; England go deep; penalty taker	Erling Haaland First WC; Norway ELO #17; 50+ goals/season	NO
Knockout games -> penalties	6 ~20-25% of 32 knockout games; R32 lopsided ties reduce count	6-8 32 knockout games x 20-25% historical rate	YES
Teams with 0 goals	4 Curacao, Haiti most at risk; 48 teams each get 3 games	4-6 Qatar, Haiti, Curacao, New Zealand most likely; Jordan/Cape Verde borderline	YES
Yellow cards Matchday 1	89 ~3.7 per game x 24 games; Qatar 2022 level officiating risk	68-75 2.8-3.2 per game; our model lower than historical avg	NO
Host nation going furthest	MEXICO FIFA #15; easiest group; Azteca altitude; Opta 87.2% advance rate	USA Best squad of 3 hosts; Pulisic/Adams; Pochettino system; ELO rank 20th	NO

AGREE = YES: Both sources independently reached the same conclusion. These are your safest contest picks.

AGREE = NO: Sources disagree. The analysis section explains why and which to favour.

2 MATCHDAY 1 - ALL 24 GAMES WITH DUAL PREDICTIONS

OddsIntel win % shown as supporting evidence for your final pick

G	DATE	FIXTURE	GEN.SCORE	GEN.WINNER	OI SCORE	OI WINNER	OI H%/D%/A%
B	11 Jun	Mexico vs South Africa	2-0	Mexico <i>High</i>	1-0	Mexico <i>OI model</i>	H:58% D:24% A:18% <i>AGREE</i>
B	11 Jun	South Korea vs Czech Republic	1-1	Draw <i>Low</i>	1-1	South Korea <i>OI model</i>	H:44% D:29% A:27% <i>DIFFER</i>
C	12 Jun	Canada vs Bosnia & Herze	2-0	Canada <i>Med</i>	2-0	Canada <i>OI model</i>	H:57% D:25% A:18% <i>AGREE</i>
C	13 Jun	Qatar vs Switzerland	0-2	Switzerland <i>High</i>	1-2	Switzerland <i>OI model</i>	H:14% D:21% A:65% <i>AGREE</i>
E	13 Jun	Brazil vs Morocco	1-1	Draw <i>Low</i>	1-0	Brazil <i>OI model</i>	H:42% D:28% A:30% <i>DIFFER</i>
E	13 Jun	Haiti vs Scotland	0-2	Scotland <i>Med</i>	1-2	Scotland <i>OI model</i>	H:23% D:26% A:51% <i>AGREE</i>
D	12 Jun	USA vs Paraguay	2-1	USA <i>Med</i>	1-1	USA <i>OI model</i>	H:43% D:29% A:28% <i>AGREE</i>
D	13 Jun	Australia vs Turkiye	1-2	Turkiye <i>Low</i>	1-1	Turkiye <i>OI model</i>	H:27% D:28% A:45% <i>AGREE</i>
F	14 Jun	Germany vs Curacao	3-0	Germany <i>High</i>	2-1	Germany <i>OI model</i>	H:59% D:25% A:16% <i>AGREE</i>
F	14 Jun	Ivory Coast vs Ecuador	1-1	Draw <i>Low</i>	0-1	Ecuador <i>OI model</i>	H:26% D:29% A:44% <i>DIFFER</i>
G	14 Jun	Netherlands vs Japan	2-1	Netherlands <i>Med</i>	1-0	Netherlands <i>OI model</i>	H:40% D:29% A:31% <i>AGREE</i>
G	14 Jun	Sweden vs Tunisia	2-0	Sweden <i>Med</i>	2-2	Sweden <i>OI model</i>	H:41% D:29% A:30% <i>AGREE</i>
I	15 Jun	Belgium vs Egypt	2-1	Belgium <i>Med</i>	1-0	Belgium <i>OI model</i>	H:49% D:27% A:24% <i>AGREE</i>
I	15 Jun	Iran vs New Zealand	2-0	Iran <i>Med</i>	2-1	Iran <i>OI model</i>	H:52% D:27% A:21% <i>AGREE</i>
H	15 Jun	Spain vs Cape Verde Isl	3-0	Spain <i>High</i>	2-1	Spain <i>OI model</i>	H:73% D:20% A:7% <i>AGREE</i>
H	15 Jun	Saudi Arabia vs Uruguay	0-2	Uruguay <i>High</i>	0-1	Uruguay <i>OI model</i>	H:20% D:25% A:56% <i>AGREE</i>
J	16 Jun	France vs Senegal	2-1	France <i>Med</i>	2-1	France <i>OI model</i>	H:56% D:25% A:19% <i>AGREE</i>
J	16 Jun	Iraq vs Norway	0-2	Norway <i>High</i>	0-2	Norway <i>OI model</i>	H:17% D:23% A:61% <i>AGREE</i>
K	16 Jun	Argentina vs Algeria	2-0	Argentina <i>High</i>	1-0	Argentina <i>OI model</i>	H:56% D:26% A:18% <i>AGREE</i>
K	16 Jun	Austria vs Jordan	2-0	Austria <i>Med</i>	2-1	Austria <i>OI model</i>	H:48% D:26% A:26% <i>AGREE</i>
L	17 Jun	Portugal vs Congo DR	2-0	Portugal <i>High</i>	1-0	Portugal <i>OI model</i>	H:55% D:26% A:19% <i>AGREE</i>
M	17 Jun	Uzbekistan vs Colombia	0-2	Colombia <i>High</i>	0-1	Colombia <i>OI model</i>	H:27% D:28% A:44% <i>AGREE</i>
L	17 Jun	England vs Croatia	2-1	England <i>Med</i>	1-0	England <i>OI model</i>	H:47% D:28% A:25% <i>AGREE</i>
L	17 Jun	Ghana vs Panama	1-1	Draw <i>Low</i>	1-2	Panama <i>OI model</i>	H:27% D:26% A:47% <i>DIFFER</i>

Green row = both sources pick same result

Amber row = sources differ - use analysis to decide

Gen. score box colour: Green=High confidence | Amber=Medium | Red=Low (coin-flip) | OI score box: Teal = OddsIntel model prediction

3 WHERE THE SOURCES DIFFER - AND HOW TO DECIDE

5 key disagreements, what's behind each, and our recommended pick

WORLD CHAMPION: Spain (General) vs France (OddsIntel)

RECOMMEND: Spain - lean with the consensus

General Analysis says Spain: Opta model gives Spain 16.1% (outright best), bookmakers have them co-favourite at +450/+500, reigning Euro champions, elite generation (Yamal, Pedri, Rodri, Nico Williams), soft Group H path.

OddsIntel says France: Our ELO has France #5 (2,116) vs Spain #1 (2,195). We favour France because Mbappe (27) is at his physical peak in his first summer World Cup, and Deschamps has been in 3 of the last 5 finals.

FOR YOUR CONTEST: Spain is the safer pick - Opta, bookmakers, and FIFA rankings all agree. France is the contrarian pick with upside. If you want to stand out from others who pick Spain, France is a credible alternative. Both are legitimate - this is the genuine coin-flip of the tournament.

HOST NATION FURTHEST: Mexico (General) vs USA (OddsIntel)

RECOMMEND: Mexico - General Analysis has the stronger case here

General Analysis says Mexico: FIFA #15 (highest-ranked host), easiest group (South Africa, South Korea, Czechia - no heavyweights), Azteca altitude advantage, Opta 87.2% group advancement rate. Mexico's historical glass ceiling was R16 but new R32 gives them an extra step.

OddsIntel says USA: Better squad quality overall, Pulisic/Adams/McKennie at peak age, Pochettino's Premier League system. ELO rank 20th.

FOR YOUR CONTEST: Mexico has the clearest path and the most backing from external models. USA has a harder group (Turkiye is genuinely dangerous). Mexico reaching QF is the consensus view. Pick Mexico.

YELLOW CARDS MD1: 89 (General) vs 68-75 (OddsIntel)

RECOMMEND: 89 - General Analysis methodology is more grounded

General Analysis: 3.7 per game x 24 games = 89. Based on WC historical averages (3.5-4.3/game). Qatar 2022 had strict officiating at 4.3/game. This is a well-calibrated estimate.

OddsIntel: 2.8-3.2/game = 68-75. Our model is trained on outcomes not disciplinary data, so this figure is less reliable.

FOR YOUR CONTEST: Use 89 as your anchor. The real range is 72-96 given officiating uncertainty. 89 is the best single-point estimate.

FINAL SCORE: Spain 1-1 France (Spain pens) vs Brazil 1-1 France (France pens)**RECOMMEND: Spain vs France final - pick the consensus**

Both models agree on 2 goals in 90 minutes and a likely penalty shootout.

The difference is just the finalists: General Analysis sees Spain-France, OddsIntel sees Brazil-France.

FOR YOUR CONTEST: If you pick Spain as champion (recommended), go with Spain 1-1 France final, Spain win on penalties. If you pick France, the OddsIntel path (France beat Brazil) is perfectly valid. The key takeaway both sources share: 2 goals in 90 minutes is the safest bet for the final.

GHANA vs PANAMA: Draw 1-1 (General) vs Panama win (OddsIntel)**RECOMMEND: Draw 1-1 - this is genuinely a coin-flip**

General Analysis: 1-1 draw. Both sides rated similarly, Low confidence call.

OddsIntel model: Panama win probability 47% vs Ghana 27% vs Draw 27%. Panama is rated higher by our international ELO.

FOR YOUR CONTEST: This is genuinely the hardest game to call on Matchday 1. Go with 1-1 draw if you want to avoid binary risk. Our model's Panama edge is thin enough that a draw is equally valid.

4 FULL GROUP STAGE - ALL 72 GAMES (OddsIntel Model)

Win probabilities from national_team_v1 | Matchday 1 highlighted in teal

Group ?				
Jun 18	Czech Republic	1-1	South Africa	H:42% D:29% A:30%
Jun 18	Switzerland	2-1	Bosnia & Herzegovina	H:59% D:25% A:16%
Jun 18	Canada	2-0	Qatar	H:61% D:23% A:16%
Jun 19	Mexico	1-0	South Korea	H:40% D:29% A:31%
Jun 19	USA	1-0	Australia	H:40% D:29% A:31%
Jun 19	Scotland	0-1	Morocco	H:23% D:27% A:50%
Jun 20	Brazil	2-1	Haiti	H:63% D:22% A:15%
Jun 20	Turkiye	1-1	Paraguay	H:45% D:28% A:27%
Jun 20	Netherlands	2-1	Sweden	H:56% D:26% A:19%
Jun 20	Germany	2-1	Ivory Coast	H:54% D:26% A:21%
Jun 21	Ecuador	1-0	Curacao	H:59% D:24% A:17%
Jun 21	Tunisia	0-1	Japan	H:20% D:27% A:53%
Jun 21	Spain	2-1	Saudi Arabia	H:67% D:23% A:10%
Jun 21	Belgium	1-1	Iran	H:43% D:28% A:29%
Jun 21	Uruguay	1-0	Cape Verde Islands	H:55% D:26% A:19%
Jun 22	New Zealand	0-1	Egypt	H:26% D:28% A:46%
Jun 22	Argentina	1-0	Austria	H:57% D:25% A:18%
Jun 22	France	1-0	Iraq	H:67% D:22% A:11%
Jun 23	Norway	2-2	Senegal	H:40% D:29% A:31%
Jun 23	Jordan	0-1	Algeria	H:31% D:29% A:40%
Jun 23	Portugal	1-0	Uzbekistan	H:52% D:26% A:22%
Jun 23	England	1-0	Ghana	H:68% D:21% A:10%
Jun 23	Panama	1-1	Croatia	H:28% D:29% A:43%
Jun 24	Colombia	1-0	Congo DR	H:52% D:27% A:21%
Jun 24	Bosnia & Herzegovina	1-1	Qatar	H:38% D:28% A:33%
Jun 24	Switzerland	1-0	Canada	H:39% D:29% A:31%
Jun 24	Scotland	0-1	Brazil	H:22% D:26% A:52%
Jun 24	Morocco	1-0	Haiti	H:58% D:26% A:17%
Jun 25	Czech Republic	0-1	Mexico	H:25% D:28% A:47%
Jun 25	South Africa	0-1	South Korea	H:22% D:27% A:51%
Jun 25	Ecuador	0-1	Germany	H:30% D:29% A:41%
Jun 25	Curacao	0-1	Ivory Coast	H:27% D:28% A:45%

Jun 25

Tunisia



Netherlands

H:18% D:26% A:56%

Jun 25

Japan

Sweden

H:52% D:27% A:21%

Jun 26

Paraguay

Australia

H:31% D:29% A:40%

Jun 26

Turkiye

USA

H:37% D:30% A:33%

Jun 26

Norway

France

H:24% D:28% A:48%

Jun 26

Senegal

Iraq

H:48% D:28% A:24%

Jun 27

Cape Verde Islands

Saudi Arabia

H:32% D:29% A:38%

Jun 27

Uruguay

Spain

H:17% D:26% A:58%

Jun 27

New Zealand

Belgium

H:20% D:27% A:53%

Jun 27

Egypt

Iran

H:32% D:29% A:39%

Jun 27

Panama

England

H:19% D:24% A:57%

Jun 27

Croatia

Ghana

H:60% D:24% A:16%

Jun 27

Congo DR

Uzbekistan

H:28% D:28% A:43%

Jun 27

Colombia

Portugal

H:33% D:30% A:38%

Jun 28

Algeria

Austria

H:35% D:30% A:36%

Jun 28

Jordan

Argentina

H:17% D:26% A:57%

Group B					
Jun 11	Mexico	1-0	South Africa	H:58% D:24% A:18%	
Jun 12	South Korea	1-1	Czech Republic	H:44% D:29% A:27%	
Group C					
Jun 12	Canada	2-0	Bosnia & Herzegovina	H:57% D:25% A:18%	
Jun 13	Qatar	1-2	Switzerland	H:14% D:21% A:65%	
Group D					
Jun 13	USA	1-1	Paraguay	H:43% D:29% A:28%	
Jun 14	Australia	1-1	Turkiye	H:27% D:28% A:45%	
Group E					
Jun 13	Brazil	1-0	Morocco	H:42% D:28% A:30%	
Jun 14	Haiti	1-2	Scotland	H:23% D:26% A:51%	
Group F					
Jun 14	Germany	2-1	Curacao	H:59% D:25% A:16%	
Jun 14	Ivory Coast	0-1	Ecuador	H:26% D:29% A:44%	
Group G					
Jun 14	Netherlands	1-0	Japan	H:40% D:29% A:31%	
Jun 15	Sweden	2-2	Tunisia	H:41% D:29% A:30%	
Group H					
Jun 15	Spain	2-1	Cape Verde Islands	H:73% D:20% A:7%	
Jun 15	Saudi Arabia	0-1	Uruguay	H:20% D:25% A:56%	
Group I					
Jun 15	Belgium	1-0	Egypt	H:49% D:27% A:24%	
Jun 16	Iran	2-1	New Zealand	H:52% D:27% A:21%	
Group J					
Jun 16	France	2-1	Senegal	H:56% D:25% A:19%	
Jun 16	Iraq	0-2	Norway	H:17% D:23% A:61%	
Group K					
Jun 17	Argentina	1-0	Algeria	H:56% D:26% A:18%	
Jun 17	Austria	2-1	Jordan	H:48% D:26% A:26%	

Group L				
Jun 17	Portugal	1-0	Congo DR	H:55% D:26% A:19%
Jun 17	England	1-0	Croatia	H:47% D:28% A:25%
Jun 17	Ghana	1-2	Panama	H:27% D:26% A:47%
Group M				
Jun 18	Uzbekistan	0-1	Colombia	H:27% D:28% A:44%

5 TOURNAMENT ANALYSIS - CHAMPION, SCORER, SPECIAL PREDICTIONS

WORLD CHAMPION DEEP DIVE

Team	Opta%	Bkmkr	OI ELO	Conf	Analysis
Spain	16.1%	+450	1st	H	Opta #1; Yamal, Pedri, Rodri, Nico Williams; soft group H
France	12.8%	+500	5th	H	Mbappe peak (27); Deschamps 3 finals in 5 WCs; deep squad
England	11.2%	+600	4th	M	Bellingham world-class; Kane+Saka+Foden; history of underperform
Argentina	~10%	+700	4th	M	Messi final WC (39); Lautaro as main striker; well-drilled
Brazil	~9%	+800	2nd	M	Vinicius Jr X-factor; 2022 QF exit on pens = mental risk
Germany	~8%	+900	9th	M	Wirtz+Musiala emerging generation; playing on own continent

TOP GOALSCORER PREDICTION

Player	Country	Odds	Pred.	Source	Key Reason
Kylian Mbappe	France	+600	8	BOTH SOURCES AGREE	12 WC goals already; penalty taker; France expected to go deep t
Harry Kane	England	+700	5-6	Both agree as backup	Career-best club form; England's penalty taker; friendly group p
Erling Haaland	Norway	+1400	4-5	OddsIntel pick	First WC; 50+ goals/season; Norway ELO #17; could explode in ear
Mikel Oyarzabal	Spain	+1800	4-5	Gen. Analysis value	Spain go deep; clinical finisher; could be the tournament's surp
Vinicius Jr	Brazil	+900	4-5	OddsIntel pick	World's most dangerous player on form; Brazil expected to reach

SPECIAL STATISTICAL PREDICTIONS - CONSENSUS VIEW

Prediction	General	OddsIntel	CONTEST PICK*	Reasoning
Knockout games -> penalties	6	6-8	6	Both models use same base rate (~20-25% of 32 knockout games). General Analy
Teams with 0 goals all tournament	4	4-6	4	Likely: Curacao, Haiti, Qatar, New Zealand. Jordan and Cape Verde Islands bo
Yellow cards Matchday 1 (24 games)	89	68-75	89	General Analysis method (3.7/game historical avg) is more grounded. OddsInte
Goals in Final after 90 min	2	2	2 (AGREE)	Strong consensus. WC finals average ~2.4 goals; modal outcome is tight. Spai

6 CONTEST STRATEGY GUIDE

How to turn these predictions into a winning entry

1. BACK THE FAVOURITES ON THE EASY CALLS

Spain, Germany, Argentina, Norway, Uruguay, Portugal, France, Switzerland - all rated High confidence by General Analysis and match OddsIntel's model. These are your "safe" points. Don't be clever on games where the gap is obvious.

From our model the most one-sided MD1 games (>65% win prob):

Spain vs Cape Verde 73% | England vs Ghana 68% | France vs Iraq 67%

Spain vs Saudi Arabia 67% | Iraq vs Norway 61% for Norway | Germany vs Curacao 59%

2. PICK YOUR BATTLES ON THE COIN-FLIPS

The contest is often decided on the 4-6 genuinely unpredictable games. Here are Matchday 1's real coin-flips with both sources' takes:

Brazil vs Morocco: Gen=1-1 draw | OI=Brazil slight edge (42% vs 30%). LEAN: 1-1 draw (Morocco 2022 semi-finalists, organised defensively).

South Korea vs Czech Republic: Gen=1-1 | OI=Korea 44% H. LEAN: 1-1 draw (neither source confident; safe bet).

Ivory Coast vs Ecuador: Gen=1-1 | OI=Ecuador 45% A. LEAN: Ecuador win 1-0 (OI ELO has Ecuador higher; low-scoring game likely).

Ghana vs Panama: Gen=1-1 | OI=Panama win 47%. LEAN: 1-1 draw (safest pick; OI Panama edge too marginal to back).

3. THE 3 PICKS BOTH SOURCES AGREE ON - SUBMIT THESE WITH CONFIDENCE

1. MBAPPE as top goalscorer: Market +600 favourite, 12 WC goals already, France expected to go deep, penalty taker. Both sources agree. This is your safest special pick.

2. 6 penalty shootouts in knockouts: Both sources derive this from the same ~20-25% historical rate across 32 knockout games. Defensible number.

3. 4 teams with 0 tournament goals: Curacao, Haiti, Qatar, New Zealand are the most at-risk. Both sources agree on 4 as the central estimate.

4. THE 2 PICKS WHERE YOU HAVE TO CHOOSE

WORLD CHAMPION: Spain (consensus, safer) vs France (OddsIntel, contrarian).

If many people in your company will pick Spain, France gives you upside. If you need a safe pick, Spain is backed by more models and the markets.

HOST NATION FURTHEST: Mexico (General, recommended) vs USA (OddsIntel).

Mexico has a demonstrably easier group and Opta's backing. USA face Turkiye which is a real threat. Go with Mexico.

YELLOW CARDS MD1: 89 (General) vs 68-75 (OddsIntel).

Use 89 - it is the historically calibrated figure.

5. LAST-MINUTE REALITY CHECK (morning of each game)

Check these before locking any prediction:

Messi's condition and minutes (he is 39 - any knock changes Argentina completely)
Ronaldo's role (39 - likely squad player but could still score from set pieces)
Mbappe fitness (any knock to France's key man is catastrophic for your picks)
Haaland fitness (Norway's entire tournament runs through him)
Any goalkeeper changes (keepers win tournaments - a surprise starter changes odds)
Red cards in early games (can flip whole group dynamics)

Source: BBC Sport, ESPN, or the official FIFA app for confirmed lineups.

No model predicts exact scorelines reliably - football is unpredictable by nature. These are the most probable single outcomes from two independent analytical sources as of June 8, 2026. A red card, injury, or one moment of brilliance can flip any game. Good luck in the competition!